
NEW SUBSIDY
210,000
50 → 25 BTC

THE FIRST HALVING

015 / 28 NOV 2012 / BITCOIN / LEGENDARY

50 TO 25.

On 28 November 2012, Bitcoin reached block 210,000 and its first halving. The new-coin subsidy fell from 50 to 25 BTC per block. The network had reached the first milestone in a schedule that repeats every 210,000 blocks, approximately every four years. The date followed the arrival of the block, rather than triggering it.

A halving is part of Bitcoin's existing issuance rules, not a software upgrade or a calendar alarm. It reduces newly created bitcoin, not the coins people already hold. Transaction fees are separate from the subsidy. The rule does not itself restrict buying, determine mining difficulty or guarantee a higher market price.

The golden valley imagines new issuance as a tributary feeding a river that is already flowing. A young miner watches the first milestone from the left bank. Place card 015 beside card 093, with 015 on the left, and the two views reveal one wider landscape. The returning figure, mountain horizon and connected river link 2012 with 2024. This is a comparison across time, not a literal scene or a chart of Bitcoin's price.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 The first milestone

210,000 is the first halving block. The plaque labels the flow NEW SUBSIDY, separating new issuance from existing bitcoin.

02 50 to 25 BTC

The plaque gives the exact reduction per block. The broad golden outlet is a metaphor, not a measured hydraulic model.

03 The single tally

One engraved stroke above the plaque marks the first halving, echoed by four strokes on card 093.

04 The returning explorer

The headlamp, teal jacket and backpack connect the seated miner here with the standing figure across the paired panorama.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: Bitcoin halving history; Bitcoin developer guide: block chain. Fictional editorial panorama, not a real location or price forecast. Native art: 750 x 1048 pixels; 90.71 effective PPI at this A4 fit. Print QA pending; no native-resolution enhancement claimed.